

5-4-3-2-1 Grounding Technique

A Sensory Awareness Exercise for Anxiety & Distress

When you feel anxious, overwhelmed, or disconnected, use this technique to anchor yourself in the present moment. Engage each of your five senses slowly and deliberately. Take your time with each step.

5

THINGS YOU CAN SEE

Look around you. Name 5 things you can see right now.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

4

THINGS YOU CAN TOUCH

Notice textures and sensations. Name 4 things you can physically feel.

1.

2.

3.

4.

3

THINGS YOU CAN HEAR

Listen carefully. Name 3 sounds you can hear right now.

1.

2.

3.

2

THINGS YOU CAN SMELL

Breathe in. Name 2 things you can smell (or like to smell).

1.

2.

1

THING YOU CAN TASTE

Notice your mouth. Name 1 thing you can taste right now.

1.

After completing: Take 3 slow, deep breaths. Notice how you feel now compared to when you started.